Lab 08: One-Point Perspective: Pop-up Aisle

Level: Intermediate Suggested time: 75 minutes Platform: Complete the core brief in either Procreate or Sketchbook Studio; use the comparison notes to transfer the workflow. Alignment: K10 | A2 | LO2

Scenario

An arts retailer needs a concept sketch of a compact pop-up aisle viewed from its entrance.

Your role: Environment concept artist Required deliverable: A one-point perspective interior with shelves, signs and three depth cues.

Learning goal

Apply Horizon | vanishing point | drawing guide or ruler | scale recession | overlap to a real design decision and produce evidence that meets explicit acceptance criteria.

Before you begin

- Use an iPad that supports your chosen app and a compatible stylus where available.
- Save an editable, layered master before exporting a flattened image.
- Use only owned, licensed or clearly permitted reference images and record their sources.
- Create a folder named Lab-08-<YourName> for working files and evidence.

Part A - Plan and construct

1. Define the viewer as standing at the entrance of a compact pop-up art aisle.
2. Create a landscape canvas and place one horizon and one vanishing point.
3. Block the floor, ceiling and two side walls with depth edges converging to the point.
4. Add repeated shelf bays; use diagonal guides to divide equal intervals in depth.
5. Place signs, artworks and floor objects with consistent scale recession and overlap.
6. Separate foreground, middle ground and background using detail and atmospheric contrast.
7. Hide the guide layer and verify the scene still reads; export guide-on and guide-off versions.

Part B - Procreate pathway

1. Actions → Canvas → Drawing Guide → Edit Drawing Guide → Perspective.
2. Tap once to place the vanishing point and position the horizon; choose a visible guide colour.
3. Enable Drawing Assist on the structural layer so depth strokes snap to the guide.
4. Use QuickShape for vertical and horizontal architectural edges not governed by the vanishing point.
5. Create separate layers for guides, structure, objects, colour and atmosphere.
6. Use Selection/Transform Uniform to place repeated shelf units while preserving scale logic.
7. Turn off Drawing Guide before exporting guide-off evidence; retain one guide-on screenshot.

Part C - Sketchbook Studio pathway

1. Choose the Grid page template and establish eye level across the page.

2. Use the Ruler to draw depth lines toward one manually marked vanishing point.
3. Create a separate guide layer so construction can be hidden.
4. Build shelf boxes and repeated bays; duplicate layers only when scale is corrected manually.
5. Use separate layers for line, colour and atmosphere.
6. Reduce detail and contrast in depth using opacity and restrained filters.
7. Hide the guide layer and export guide-on and guide-off evidence.

Evidence and acceptance checklist

[ ] Depth edges converge consistently

[ ] Viewer eye level is deliberate

[ ] Objects scale convincingly

[ ] Guide layer can be hidden without losing depth

[ ] Layered working file is saved and opens correctly.

[ ] Final export uses a clear filename and matches the intended dimensions.

[ ] At least one in-progress screenshot shows the technique in use.

[ ] Reference sources and design decisions are recorded.

Peer review questions

1. How does horizon height change the viewer's role?
2. Which depth cue works without guide lines?
3. Where does distortion become distracting?

Debrief

Use the Observe → Interpret → Connect → Propose pattern:

1. Observe: State what is visible without praise or blame.
2. Interpret: Explain the likely effect on attention, meaning, emotion or use.
3. Connect: Link the effect to the brief, a design principle or the acceptance criteria.
4. Propose: Name one specific change and how you will check whether it works.

Record one decision you will keep, one change you will test, and one technique you can transfer to the other app.

Troubleshooting

- The line feels wobbly: Zoom out, slow the decision rather than the stroke, use shoulder movement, and increase stabilisation only enough to preserve intent.
- Colour leaks during fill: Close the contour, inspect gaps at 100%, or place colour on a separate layer and clean with the precise eraser.
- The file becomes hard to edit: Name or document layer roles, hide unused experiments, group related stages and duplicate before merging or filtering.
- The image looks muddy: Check value grouping, lower overlay opacity, remove competing texture and restore one clear focal contrast.

- Perspective feels wrong: Return to horizon and vanishing logic; correct the large box before windows, props or decoration.

Submission package

Submit Lab-08-<YourName>/ containing:

- layered working file (or the app's saved layered sketch);
- final PNG/JPEG/PDF as required by the brief;
- progress evidence/contact sheet;
- short design rationale answering the peer-review questions; and
- reference/provenance list.

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